RESOLUTION No. 4394

Jefferson High School Dual Assignment

RECITALS

A. Over the last two years, under the leadership of the Board of Education ("Board") and the Superintendent, Portland Public Schools ("District") has engaged in an in-depth analysis of its high school system with the goal of improving its high schools to ensure better academic outcomes for all students. This process has involved input from thousands of students, staff members, families and citizens.

B. By way of Resolution No. 4236 (adopted March 8, 2010) and on Resolution No. 4357 (adopted October 12, 2010), the Board endorsed the framework of the high school system design plan, including the development and implementation of a system of focus and educational option schools. Focus and education options schools will not necessarily provide all of the elements above, because their program will be designed around a specific focus and students will elect to attend these schools. All students will also have access to one of seven community comprehensive high schools with neighborhood attendance boundaries.

C. By way of Resolution No. 4358 (adopted October 12, 2010), the Board endorsed the plan that Jefferson High School operate as a focus high school available to all students District-wide with a Middle College program that will have strong ties to the Jefferson neighborhood. Students residing in the Jefferson cluster will have a guaranteed right to attend the Middle College program.

D. In accordance with Resolution No. 4358, Boise-Eliot PK-7, a school that historically has fed into Jefferson HS, will be given dual assignment to Jefferson, as well as the current assignment to Grant High School.

E. The District is excited to have a Middle College program in partnership with Portland Community College. Students entering Jefferson HS as 9th graders in 2011-12 will participate in the Middle College program. On-going program design for the Middle College program is underway, and families and students within the Jefferson cluster have received information about the program, through a variety of means, including a series of information sessions at Jefferson HS, information flyers mailed to their homes, and information provided to all middle grades school counselors

F. Resolution No. 4358 states that students in the Jefferson attendance boundary will also have a dual assignment to one of the neighboring comprehensive programs at Roosevelt, Madison or Grant HS. As part of this process, and at the direction of the Board, District staff analyzed potential student assignment options for these students.

G. In order to make decisions in a reasonable timeframe and to minimize impact on students from kindergarten through 12th grade, the scope of this analysis was based on using K-5 and K-8 boundaries as the building blocks for new assignments. Given ongoing shifts in population and demographics, the Board has indicated that K-12 boundaries will be reviewed regularly during the implementation period of high school system design to ensure that enrollment stability and other criteria for student assignment are met, and further boundary changes are likely over time.

H. As authorized by Board policy and administrative directives, District staff developed criteria to judge various boundary options for the dual assignment zone. These criteria, which often conflict with one another, are listed below:

1. Enrollment stability: Target enrollment at comprehensive high schools is a minimum of 1300 and the difference in enrollment between comprehensive high schools should not

be more than 300 students. Facility capacity should be considered to ensure that assigned enrollment is not greater than capacity.

2. Proximity: Students should be assigned whenever feasible to the closest school to their home, and should be able to access their assigned school using TriMet in a reasonable amount of time that allows students to fully participate in their school program.

3. Student impact: Boundary decisions should minimize the total number of students reassigned and keep students together after 8th grade to the extent possible.

I. Throughout the high school system design process, economic diversity has also been an important criterion in determining boundaries. Specifically, boundary decisions should strive to establish a mix of students with different socioeconomic backgrounds across schools to the extent possible. Some research shows that economic diversity can be correlated with higher academic performance of all students at a school. However, in the case of the dual assignment zone, it is impossible to estimate with any degree of accuracy the percentage of Free and Reduced Meal-eligible students who will attend a community comprehensive school versus Jefferson HS or a focus option. Because of the resulting inaccuracy of any demographic impact analyses, economic diversity has not been used as a criterion. The District still considers economic diversity an important criterion and will continue to use it as a key consideration in all future boundary changes.

J. Arriving at a recommendation requires prioritizing the above criteria relative to one another. Throughout the high school system design process, the Board has endorsed that enrollment balance is the highest priority in order to achieve the explicit goal of ensuring access for all students to an equivalent, high quality core program in each school, which requires schools to have enrollment that falls within a similar range. Feedback from the community throughout this process has indicated that proximity is held as an extremely high value by parents and students system-wide. In the past, the Board has worked to eliminate split-feeder patterns and minimize the impact of boundary changes on existing students.

K. The impact of dual assignment will be monitored based on actual enrollment each year. Adjustments will be recommended, in order to further improve enrollment balance between schools and to allow as many students as possible to attend a school close to their home.

L. Families at all of the affected K-8 and middle schools were provided with information about their proposed dual assignment throughout the past few months, and information and input sessions about dual assignment were held in the Jefferson cluster during January 2011.

M. The Ad Hoc Committee on Student Assignment, Program Initiation and Reconfiguration ("SAPIR") reviewed the impact of this boundary change on January 13 and January 20, 2011. On January 20, SAPIR approved the Superintendent's recommendation, 3-0, and forwarded the resolution to the full Board for a decision.

RESOLUTION

1. Students living in the current Jefferson HS attendance boundary will be guaranteed enrollment at Jefferson HS or at a specific nearby community comprehensive high school, whichever they choose.

2. Students residing in the attendance boundaries of Beach K-8, Woodlawn PK-8, Chief Joseph PK-5, and Ockley Green K-8 have a dual assignment to Roosevelt High School.

3. The Faubion PK-8 attendance boundary will be split between two community comprehensive high school choices due to the large geographic area of the boundary. Students residing in the attendance boundaries of the north portion of Faubion, including the Hayden Island and Delta Park area, and all areas north of the Columbia Slough will have a dual assignment to Roosevelt.

Students residing in the attendance boundaries in the eastern portion of Faubion including the Concordia area and specifically areas south of the Columbia Slough will have a dual assignment to Madison High School.

4. Students residing in the attendance boundaries of Vernon PK-8 will have a dual assignment to Madison HS.

5. Students residing in the attendance boundaries of Humboldt PK-8 and King PK-8 will have a dual assignment to Grant HS.

6. Students residing in the attendance boundaries of Boise-Eliot PK-8, currently assigned to Grant HS as its community comprehensive, will have a dual assignment to Jefferson Middle College.

7. Implementation of all boundary changes associated with the dual assignment zone will begin for incoming 9th graders in 2011-12.

8. Jefferson HS will remain the assigned school for current high school students who reside in the Jefferson cluster. The following choices will be available to these students:

   a. Students currently attending Jefferson HS have No Child Left Behind priority to transfer through the lottery to one of two designated high schools;

   b. Students attending other high schools may apply to return to Jefferson HS and will have priority lottery; or

   c. Requests to transfer to other schools, either through the lottery or petition process, will be accommodated based on space availability.

9. Given the importance of access to TriMet for students, the Board encourages the Superintendent and District staff to continue to work with intergovernmental partners to sustain current transportation options for high school students.

S. Allan

RESOLUTION No. 4395

Sunnyside K-8 Neighborhood High School Boundary Change

RECITALS

A. Over the last two years, under the leadership of the Board of Education ("Board") and the Superintendent, Portland Public Schools ("District") has engaged in an in-depth analysis of its high school system with the goal of improving its high schools to ensure better academic outcomes for all students. This process has involved input from thousands of students, staff members, families, and citizens.

B. As part of this process and at the direction of the Board, District staff, community members, parents, and students engaged in a meaningful manner in the analysis of potential boundary options. Families at all of the affected K-8 and middle schools were contacted throughout this process using multiple communication mechanisms; administrators and staff provided input. Sunnyside K-8 was one of the schools involved in this process. In October 2010 and January 2011, all Sunnyside families received letters communicating proposed modifications to the Sunnyside feeder pattern.

C. Currently, the majority of the Sunnyside boundary feeds to Franklin High School, with a small portion feeding to Cleveland. The current feeder pattern designated 63 Sunnyside students to Franklin and 20 Sunnyside students to Cleveland (13 of the 20 students actually attend Cleveland). The streets included within the Sunnyside K-8 attendance boundary that feed to